

Characteristics that Make OG Unique and Effective:

Why OG in the 21st Century?

By Ronald Ysohimoto, Fellow /AOGPE

OG is multi-sensory - simultaneously - visual/auditory/kinaesthetic/tactile. This is the characteristic that distinguishes OG from phonics programs as well as some of the OG-based programs. Every part of the OG lesson utilises multi-sensory procedures for inputting and reinforcing or reviewing information - card drill, decoding words, spelling, introduction of concepts, dictation of sentences, reading fluency, and reading comprehension. All of these procedures are also neurologically sound.

OG is phonic/alphabet/morphemic/syntactic/semantic. Most of the basal reading programs cover components of phonics but differ in the way they address the syllabic, morphemic, syntactic and semantic levels. Additionally, the emphasis of these programs is on reading and not on spelling. If they address spelling, their scope and sequence causes more confusion. Overall, programs are not structured and sequential.

OG is linguistically sound. This is a broader view of the complexity of OG and how it differs from other programs. It looks at the grammatical, phonological, and the morphological components of language. As such, OG is ideal for teaching ELL children and adults (and general education students) and represents a more comprehensive and multimodal way of addressing the reading and spelling needs of dyslexic students.

OG is neurologically sound. Multi-sensory techniques are derived from an understanding of the neurological basis of learning, and more specifically, reading and spelling.

OG is based on best teaching practices or principles.

OG differentiates for learners and their styles of learning. OG provides a structure and sequential format, moving concrete to abstract, and from simple to complex.

There is sufficient

repetition until

a certain level

of automaticity

is demonstrated. OG has built-on scaffolding techniques throughout the instructional process. Because of this characteristic, OG is applicable for ALL students. Teachers can also use the principles of OG to teach science, math, social studies, etc.

OG is not a program but an approach. This is a critical difference between OG and the phonics programs or OG-based kits. A program is not geared to the needs of an individual student. It tends not to be diagnostic/prescriptive (and, hence, it is not clinical). There are very few multi-sensory procedures incorporated into most other {phonics} programs. The flexibility of OG practices/instruction/techniques/etc. is also not evidenced in these programs.

OG is flexible. OG is inherently flexible, as it must be, when one considers the needs of the dyslexic student. It can be used in one-on-one settings, small group settings

and whole classrooms. As a result, it is an excellent approach for the RTI model. It should be used in Tier One for all children. If some students evidence problems, OG in small groups can provide additional help in Tier Two. At times, a few students need more intensive help which OG will provide in Tier Three.

OG is emotionally and socially sound. As the students achieve success in learning, not only does their self-esteem improve, but also their way of interacting with peers and adults. They begin to look at themselves differently. OG helps students to identify their areas of strengths, and helps students develop compensatory strategies which give them a sense of empowerment. In other words, every part of the OG framework is geared to the enhancement of self-esteem - multi-sensory procedures, correction procedures, teacher verbalisations during instruction, structured and sequential progression, and integration with other areas of reading/spelling and writing.

OG is structured, sequential, cumulative and repetitive. OG is different from other phonics programs because it provides structured and sequential learning experiences. There is also sufficient repetition to enhance automaticity, and the practice is provided in many different formats to prevent boredom.

OG is clinical, OG is diagnostic/prescriptive. OG trained teachers are somewhat analogous to doctors who must assess the symptoms, plan a treatment program and then implement the treatment program. The treatment program may change based on

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how the patient has responded to the treatment. OG requires that practitioners assess, plan a lesson based on this assessment, then implement the lesson while noting issues/concerns, and revise the lesson and lesson implementation based on what has happened previously. Also a new lesson plan is developed based on what happened in the preceding lesson.

OG is a vehicle for integrating thinking skills, vocabulary development, writing skills, and content subjects. OG can be used to enhance thinking and writing skills, as well as reinforce concepts in math science, and social studies.

OG is efficient. From one activity, such as decoding words in isolation, a teacher can differentiate, teach tracking skills, nurture vocabulary development, reinforce grammar skills, and promote development of analogical skills. From the learned word section of the lesson, a teacher can teach far/near point copying and help students to identify the unfamiliar parts of the words. Dictation provides an opportunity not only to teach punctuation, capitalisation, grammar, sentence structures, paragraphing skills, and creative writing.

OG makes connections between reading, spelling, writing and oral language. This is not the case for many of the other

phonics or basal programs. The basal programs may impact decoding skills, but are not structured well for spelling. For many basal and phonics programs, the focus is on reading and not spelling. OG sees the connections between reading and spelling. There is little recognition that spelling is dependent on reading for building visual memory. By the same token, spelling instruction reinforces reading skills.

OG is a powerful instructional approach for teaching reading and spelling. It is the grandfather of all other multi-sensory structured language programs, and has been proven to be effective for over 80 years. Because of the above characteristics, it empowers both students and teachers. For the students, immediate progress is seen in language arts, thereby enhancing self-esteem. It does not just teach a series of strategies or discrete skills, but helps the students to look at learning and themselves in an integrated and holistic manner. For the teachers and tutors, OG provides a comprehensive, multi-modal, systematic, and multi-sensory framework and philosophy for teaching reading and spelling to ALL students.

OG is financially or fiscally sound. Schools do not need to spend so much money on basal programs or other multi-sensory structured language program kits. With the exception of teacher training expenses, the cost of the OG reading and spelling instructional approach is very reasonable. It is important for schools to invest in OG teacher training and provide support to the teachers.

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NEW

Starting with this issue of the Academy News, we are inviting members of the Academy to share their experiences as they continue their studies and strive to achieve membership at a higher level of professional competency in the Academy. We hope that these shared experiences will encourage and motivate other Academy trainees as they continue their own professional development.

Fellow member, Ronald Yoshimoto has kindly established an Academy Scholarship fund to allow two public school teachers to attend the Annual Conference. Scholarship recipient, Brenda Mackaness has graciously offered to write about her experiences in her Academy coursework and practicum.

My Journey

By Brenda Mackaness, Certified/AOGPE

Looking back to the year of 1997, when I became employed at the Trident Academy, I realise that the seed of passion for the Orton-Gillingham approach to educating students with dyslexia was planted in the classrooms of that school. Trident Academy's administrator insisted that all

of its faculty members be trained in the Orton-Gillingham methodology. I taught for six years at Trident Academy (Mount Pleasant, SC), immersed in their LEAD program. This is a setting consisting of one to one and/or small group instruction with OG instruction as its backbone. I was guided, inspired and encouraged by the Fellows Susan McConoughey and Joannie Gerken to attain my Subscriber and Associate levels of training by 2001.

Interested in pursuing an opportunity to teach older students, I followed Fellow Susan McConoughey to a university setting (Johnson & Wales University). I found that I could generalise my OG training to any academic subject, and apply it with students of any age. Using the OG principles, I was able to assist many student to overcome reading and writing issues in their language, science, and math requirements that were hampering their goals for graduation. When Johnson & Wales University relocated its campus to North Carolina, I, unable to follow the move with them, pursued opportunities to teach in the public school system in Charleston, South Carolina. I continued employing my OG skills when I became employed by an innovative principal at James Island Charter High School. I realised that this new responsibility required the obligation for me to receive more OG training. I located a Fellow who was willing to train me for the requirements of the Certified level of instruction and competence. I travelled from Charleston, South Carolina to Rhode Island three to four times a year, for three years, working under the Fellow Andrea Greer Sylvia. She flew to Charleston twice during that three year period and observed and critiqued my tutoring sessions with students at the charter high school as well as with my students at the Outreach Program at Trident Academy in Mount Pleasant. I achieved "certified" level of competency in October of 2010. With encouragement from fellow, Andrea, Sylvia, and an offer of mentorship from fellow, Sheila Costello, I started the process of fulfilling my Fellow-in-training requirements shortly after receiving my Certified Level certificate.

Since I have begun my FIT, I have been twice publicly acknowledged by my principal at the charter high school for the significant progress that my student have achieved. He has been sufficiently impressed with improved student academic test scores and consistent positive parental and faculty feedback, that he made the unprecedented decision to allow me to exclusively teach OG based support classes for students who are significantly challenged with reading and writing. As far as I know, this is the only school in Charleston, SC who has a full time, FIT faculty member using OG therapy with students at the high school level. These students come from diverse cultures, and those students struggling with the challenges, restrictions and lack of academic support that often evolve from low, socioeconomic family situations. The challenges are many, but the rewards are huge. These students, once trust has been established, flourish and thrive with the individualised instruction and attention. Every student that I have been able to work with broadens my experience and knowledge with not only specific OG skills, but they offer opportunities to...

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Definition and Characteristics of Dyslexia

“Dyslexia is a specific learning disability that is neurological in origin. It is characterised by difficulties with accurate and/or fluent word recognition and by poor spelling and decoding abilities. These difficulties typically result from a deficit in the phonological component of language that is often unexpected in relation to other cognitive abilities and the provision of effective classroom instruction. Secondary consequences may include problems in reading comprehension and reduced reading experience that can impede vocabulary growth and background knowledge.” Adopted by the International Dyslexia Association Board of Directors, November 2002.

General

- Disability is not due to visual and hearing impairments
- Disability is not due to social-emotional disorders or to socio-cultural deprivation
- It is typical, that a history or learning disability, may present within families (genetic components)
- Life-long condition – there is no cure. Children do not outgrow their dyslexia.
- Difficulty in processing the written language
- Phonological and / or orthographic processing deficits
- May also have:
- Weak auditory short term or working memory
- Sequencing problems – following directions, math steps, keyboarding, hand directions issues (left/right orientation, up/down. East/west, etc.) – surfaces in math/writing
- Time concepts and time management/organisation problems

Reading

- Reversals b/d, “bad for dad”
 - Rotations p/b, m/w, n/u “me” for “we”
 - Transpositions “saw” for “was” “from” for “form”
 - Deletes, changes or adds suffixes in words
 - Slow laboured oral reading of words in isolation with numerous errors. Substitution of similar looking words – “house” for “horse”. Omits words – common omissions of small words such as *a, an, the, to, are*. Inserts words.
 - Oral reading is not fluent (slow rate with inaccurate decoding and little expression; does not pay attention to punctuation marks)
 - Child/adult becomes easily tired after reading for a short time
 - Reading comprehension is low due to weak decoding; listening comprehension is often higher than reading comprehension.
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| Spelling | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Reverses, transposes and rotates letters• Deletes and adds letters “plat” for “plant”• Visual memory does not assist “kut” for “cut” “kook” for “cook”• Persistent misspellings of common non-phonetic words such as “they” or “was”• Spelling errors occur when copying from the board or a book |
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| Handwriting | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Writing is slow and laboured• Unusual or tight pencil grip• Letter formations are poor; child evidences unusual beginning and ending points• Poor alignment of letters• Variable slant and carriage spacing between letters Words are pushed together or widely spaced |
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| Written Expression | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Writing is slow and laboured• Many spelling errors despite proof reading• Quantity is restricted – tends to write short sentences / paragraphs• Child may have creative ideas but not reflected in writings – improvement noted when using computer and spell check• Tends to use words that they know how to spell• Dysgraphia – handwriting and other issues (putting thoughts on paper, paragraphing skills, sentence, structure, grammar, punctuation, capitalising, etc.) |
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| Maths | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Difficulty solving word problems• Difficulty in mastering math facts• Poor number formations, process confusion, misaligned numbers, number reversals, and errors in number sequencing |
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Social

- Low self esteem
- Low frustration tolerance
- interpreting nonverbal cues
- Making and keeping friends
- Misses subtleties of jokes, puns, etc.
- Social judgement
- Weak problem solving/coping skills
- Difficulty in accepting changes in routine

Other

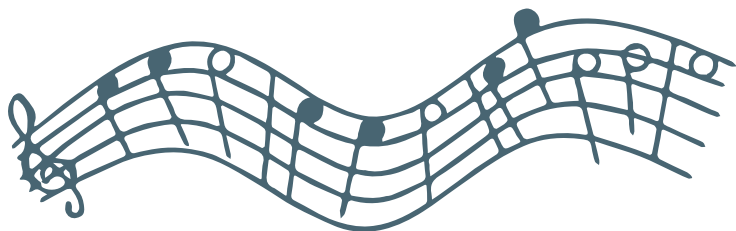
- Articulation issues
 - Word retrieval problems
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POSSIBLE STRENGTHS

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| • Artistic ability | • Musical ability | • 3D visual- spacial skills |
| • Mechanical aptitude | • Vivid imagination | • Creativity |
| • Global thinker | • Intuition | • Curiosity / tenacity |
| • Perceptive, empathetic,
compassionate | • Advanced language | • Advanced social skills |
| | • Flair for performing arts | • Math conceptualisation skills |



$$X = \frac{-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac}}{2a}$$



DISTINGUISHED DYSLLEXICS

Athletics	Bruce Jenner (Gold Medalist Olympic pentathlon), Nolan Ryan (baseball), Greg Lougannis (gold medalist Olympic diver), Magic Johnson (basketball), Russell White (football player), Jackie Stewart (race car driver), Carl Lewis (Olympic gold medalist, track and field), Pete Rose (baseball), Terry Bradshaw (football), Rulon Gardner (gold medalist, wrestling Greco-Roman).
Business	Henry Ford, Charles Swab, Pail Orfoles (founder of Kinkos), Thomas Watson, Jr. (CEO IBM), Lewis Presto (Chairman Morgan Guarantee), Delos R Smith (economist), Tommy Hilfiger (designer), William Hewlett (Hewlett Packard), David Murdoch (CEO Dole foods), Richard Branson (Virgin Airlines), Donald Winkler (CEO Ford Motor Company), John Chambers (CISCO Systems), Walt Disney.
Politics	Winston Churchill, Woodrow Wilson, John F Kennedy, Nelson Rockefeller, Robert F Kennedy, Prince Charles, Benjamin Franklin.
Performing Arts, Comedians, Singers	George Burns, Tracey Gold, Steven Cannell, Edward James Olmos, Danny Glover, Dustin Hoffman, Whoopi Goldberg, Cher, Henry Winkler, Tom Cruise, Steven Spielberg, Jack Nicholson, Harry Belafonte, John Lennon, Rom Smothers, Fanny Flagg, Susan Hampshire, Jay Leno, Robert Blake, Anne Bancroft, Dom Delouise, Quentin Tarantino.
Arts	Michelangelo, Augustin Rodin, Leonardo Da Vinci, Malcolm Alexander, Robert Rauschenberg, Charles Schulz (Peanuts), Pablo Picasso, Vincent Van Gough.
Literary	Agatha Christie, Jules Verne, Mark Twain, John Irving, F. Scott Fitzgerald, Hans Christian Anderson, Lewis Carrol. Robert Lowell (poet), William Butler Yeats, Edgar Alan Poe, William James (philosopher).
Military	Napoleon Bonaparte, Dwight D Eisenhower, General George Patton, General Westmoreland.
Scientists	Albert Einstein, Michael Faraday (physicist), Larry Silver (psychiatrist/author). Thomas Edison, Harvey Cushing (physician / brain surgeon), Edward Hallowell, Galileo, Alexander Graham Bell, Wright Brothers, Henry Ford.
Aussies	Jessica Watson – the 2010 Australian Geographic's Young Adventurer of the Year, round the world solo sailor Alex Edmonson – Olympic Cyclist Jackie French – Author and Snr Australian of the year in 2015 Dick Smith – Entrepreneur, business owner and adventurer, and 1986 Australian of the year.

US STATISTICS

- Dyslexia is the most common of all Specific Learning Disorders
- 50% of students in special education have Specific Learning Disorders
- 75-80% of special education students with Specific Learning Disorders have their basic deficit in language and reading
- Dyslexia is the leading cause of reading failure and school dropouts
- Reading failure is the most commonly shared characteristic of juvenile justice offenders
- 50% of juvenile delinquents tested were found to have learning disabilities
- 60% of adults in treatment for substance abuse have learning disabilities
- 60% of adults with severe literacy problems have undetected learning disabilities
- 62% of students with learning disability were unemployed one year after graduation
- Of children evidencing reading problems in 1st grade, 74% will be poor readers in 9th grade
- Dyslexia and ADD frequently co-exist
- Dyslexia occurs in boys and girls at the same rate